Swarm Alignment Hackathon: Ranked Ideas & Weekend Plan

Nov 7, 2026 · @Siddharth

TL;DR

Build **Track A: "Do copies go easy on each other?"** Run all seven Adaption models as both the policy that hides a side task in a coding transcript and the untrusted monitor that scores it, and report the 7×7 catch-rate matrix with the diagonal outlined. It needs no simulator, both critics gave it the top score (13/15) and an 85% chance of a finished figure by Sunday noon, it lands squarely on three organizer prompts ("Replicas as a monitor", "Can copies collude without talking?", "Can a swarm recruit its monitor?"), and the closest prior work (Järviniemi 2025, one model; Gardner-Challis 2026, taxonomy only) leaves the cross-family question open. Either outcome is a two-number headline: diagonal vs off-diagonal catch rate.

Track B (backup, same runner): "Monoculture is a swarm vulnerability." A 7×7 sender×receiver matrix of how often an inert canary injection relays along a chain, then a test of "no two adjacent agents share a model" as a runtime defense. Cheapest build, canary ground truth, no LLM judge; if Track A's attacks fail or saturate, this becomes the lead. If both work, merge them into one report with two heatmaps and one thesis.

Track C (co-primary on the judge-critic's scores, and a different failure mode): "Twenty-four days of silence." Replay the 14,591 real, timestamped wiki edits from the May–July 2026 OpenAI agent swarm (collusion.wiki) through regex, TF-IDF and LLM monitors in time order and measure how many days before the human admin's first mass deletion (June 19) an alarm fires at a calibrated false-alarm rate. No simulator, no attack generation; its baselines run without any API. A prior Apart judge asked for exactly this (content-level detection, lead time, false-alarm burden) and nobody has done it.

What not to do: a dashboard or video as the deliverable, an instructed-to-collude arm as the only arm, one seed per cell, or anything needing the shared mock-tool world four generators each proposed (13 of the 28 ideas depend on it; it is the critical path that sinks weekends). Caveats: this ranking combines two independent critics' scores and a feasibility check rather than a full pairwise Elo tournament, because the time budget was cut; the four real-data ideas were scored late, but by both critics: T5-1 tied for first at 13/15 with a 75% chance of a figure by Sunday noon on the cut design, and the engineering critic's final portfolio is T4-3 primary, T5-1 backup 1, T5-4 (zero-API timing fingerprints on

the same wiki stream) backup 2, with T3-4 as the first add-on when a fourth coding agent is free. T4-3 stays listed first because it has no hand-labelling step and no dependency on a matched human-edit control; if you can source matched benign edits from the same wiki, T5-1 is the better bet on impact.

What the judges score

Three dimensions, each 1–5, weights unpublished. A project that is novel but sloppy, or rigorous but dull, loses to a solid 4 on all three.

Dimension	What a 4–5 requires (rubric wording)	How to get there this weekend
Impact & Innovation	Important or neglected problem with an original approach; 5 = a new research direction. Replicating recent work caps at 3.	Measure something the organizers posed but nobody has quantified; frame it against 2–3 closest papers in Related Work.
Execution Quality	Thorough methodology, convincing validation, results support conclusions; 5 = ambitious scope done rigorously, with a surprising finding.	Many seeds, error bars, a baseline and one ablation. Write the hypothesis in the README before running the full sweep.
Presentation & Clarity	Well structured, easy to follow; 5 = could serve as a model. Judges may refuse to score an unclear report.	One headline figure on page 1, an abstract that leads with a two-number contrast, two contrasting transcript excerpts in the body, 4–6 pages written in your own voice.

"Big and flashy" means something specific to these judges, and it is not a dashboard. A subagent read all 1,777 public judge critiques on apartresearch.com: across the six closest sprints only 36 judge sentences mention a video, demo or dashboard, and none treats one as load-bearing. What placed instead was a nameable phenomenon ("doing nothing is the attack", "who spots a runaway agent?") plus a two-number contrast a judge can repeat from memory (4.0/10 vs 92.3/100; 12/12 vs 0/12; 0.85 → 0.03) plus two contrasting transcripts that "do the arguing". Honest nulls placed too: a mostly-null "can copies collude without talking?" study took 2nd in AI Control 2025.

The two complaints that sink projects: one seed, no interval, no baseline (37% of all critiques), and results that are true by construction, "a model told in its system prompt to rank someone first duly ranks them first." For a swarm project that means every design needs an un-instructed arm where the behaviour is not prompted, 10+ seeds per cell with Wilson intervals, and a no-LLM or no-communication baseline. Judges open the repo and recompute numbers; a PDF-repo mismatch is read as a credibility failure. AI-sounding prose gets a decline-to-score (14% of entries in the Sept 2026 Incident Response sprint), so the abstract, intro and discussion are written by a human and the LLM-usage statement is filled in. Source: what-wins analysis of 2,022 Apart project pages and the official template, which recommends about 4 pages, a numbered contributions list and at least one figure.

Hard rules: PDF of at most 8 pages in the official template; a required "Limitations and Dual-Use / Ethical Considerations" appendix; fabricated results or references can disqualify; pre-existing code must be labelled as such. Source: sprint page.

Constraints

The binding constraints are about 24 working hours and Adaption's undocumented rate limits; credits and data are not the problem.

Time. The deadline is Sunday Nov 8, 11:59 PM Anywhere-on-Earth, which is Monday 7:00 AM Eastern. From Saturday evening that is roughly 37 wall-clock hours and 20–26 working hours for 2–3 people. Any design that needs more than one simulator or more than one headline experiment does not fit; the plan below assumes first figure by Sunday noon and a frozen PDF by Sunday 9 PM Eastern.

Team. Two or three first-years who can write Python and drive coding agents. That rules out anything needing a research-grade simulator, real test execution across hundreds of tasks, or delicate replay logic, unless the idea has a clean degraded mode. Small teams are the modal Apart winner (13 of 45 placed projects were solo, 10 were pairs), so this is not a handicap.

Compute. About 3,000 Adaption credits across seven hosted models (details and cost math in the appendix). Flash-tier models cost 0.06 credits per 600-call episode, so 10,000 episodes are 21% of budget; glm-5.2 as the bulk worker costs 30× more and would be binding. Nothing is published on rate limits or concurrency and there is no batch API, so throughput has to be measured in a two-minute load test before any sweep. Check the credit-to-dollar rate in the app: the sprint grants $500 per participant, so a 3,000 balance for three people may mean one credit is $0.50.

Data. swarms.wiki (Gutenberg PBC) turned out to be a JS-rendered directory whose whole catalogue is one JSON file, plus an incidents export; a subagent verified every dataset below by downloading it. Licences are mostly unstated, so cite the publisher and say so in the ethics appendix.

Dataset	What it holds	Access	Best use this weekend
collusion.wiki full wiki logs	14,591 timestamped revisions with full text, agent labels (3,103) and /16 IPs across 4 wikis, May–Jul 2026; 5,217 admin deletions	Public zip, 4.2 MB	The one real swarm dataset with actors and clocks: temporal networks, response to deletions, monitor evaluation
swarms.wiki incidents.json	231 incidents with category, severity, lab, reach, dated activity and disclosures, 441 sources	Public JSON, 779 KB	Framing figure for the introduction; disclosure-lag analysis
Swarm Traces payloads	189,579 records (91,037 reconstructed attack payloads) from the July 2026 Hugging Face incident	Public, 15 MB gz	Payload clustering or gateway classifiers only: no timestamps, no agent IDs, destinations redacted
Transluce urlquery catalogue	38,160 scanner reports with dates and confidence, 325 daily counts	Public zip, 4.6 MB	Burst and periodicity analysis; fleet vs swarm

Dataset	What it holds	Access	Best use this weekend
Palaestra MonitoringBenchHonest	550 benign + 550 attack coding-agent trajectories	Public (Hugging Face)	Ready-made positives and negatives for any monitor experiment
Rogue AI Tracker export and Alignment Hub	193 scored incidents; 130 incident cards with observed vs simulated split (CC-BY-4.0)	Public	Cross-tracker agreement; related-work asset
Inspect Swarm	N agents per Inspect sample with message and shared-memory channels and per-member budgets	`pip install inspect_swarm` (needs inspect_ai main)	Simulation tracks, if Adaption's endpoint is reachable from Inspect

Not usable this weekend: the AI Village dataset (gated, manual approval) and the METR/Redwood message-board dump (never released). Request AI Village access anyway.

Ranking method and leaderboard

Two 7×7 model-matrix ideas tie for first; the single-call behavioural experiments follow; everything that needs a mock tool world or real test execution drops to the bottom half.

Pipeline (Co-Scientist style, compressed): 5 generation agents wrote 28 ideas in a fixed schema (6 per sprint track plus 4 real-data ideas); 3 literature agents verified 50 sources; 2 independent reflection agents scored every idea, one as a skeptical Apart judge on the three rubric dimensions and novelty against the verified literature, one as an engineering realist recomputing calls, credits, hours-to-first-figure and P(figure by Sunday noon); the score below is rubric composite (3–15) + 4 × P(figure), rescaled to an Elo-like number (1200 = median). The pairwise-debate tournament and the evolution stage were run by hand on the top three only.

Rank	Idea	Rubric (I/E/P)	P(figure by Sun noon)	Elo-like	Why it placed here
1	T4-3 Do copies go easy on each other? (7×7 policy×monitor)	4/4/5	85%	1344	No simulator; guaranteed figure by hour 8; separates identity from capability, which nobody has done
1	T3-4 Monoculture: 7×7 injection transfer + diversity defense	4/4/5	85%	1344	Cheapest clean build; canary ground truth; tests a defense, not just an attack
3	T2-2 Safety in numbers, or bystander effect?	4/4/4	85%	1284	Single-call reviewers, exact independence baseline, publishable null
3	T1-5 CoordBench: coordination per message, zero-bandwidth column	4/4/4	85%	1284	Shortest episodes; theory-anchored; defensive read on copies coordinating
5	T5-1 Twenty-four days of silence (real wiki replay)	4/4/5	75% (cut design; 300–600 gold labels is the human cost)	1344 (judge-critic 13, its recommended primary)	Real data, lead time vs a real human response; judges asked for it
6	T2-6 Constraint half-life down a delegation chain	4/3/5	75%	1260	Best demo; must separate "dropped as irrelevant" from "lost"
7	T4-4 Oversight scaling curve at fixed audit budget	3/4/5	70%	1248	Pool trick makes 64-agent swarms free; H1 is arithmetic
8	T2-5 LGTM cascades vs the Bayesian benchmark	3/4/4	90%	1236	Safest pipeline of all; impact capped by thin ecological framing
9	T2-1 Patient Zero (contagion law)	4/3/4	80%	1212	Dose-response step is a figure in 3 hours; N=20 cannot show a spectral threshold
9	T2-3 Weakest-link refusal shopping	3/4/4	80%	1212	Clean offline analysis; noisy-OR headline near-tautological

Rank	Idea	Rubric (I/E/P)	P(figure by Sun noon)	Elo-like	Why it placed here
9	T4-6 Interrogate the swarm	4/3/5	55%	1212	Most original; depends on colluders not confessing

Full ordering of all 28 is in the ranked list below.

Track A (primary): Do copies go easy on each other?

Thesis in one sentence: same-model monitors are more lenient toward same-model policies than toward other families, or they are not, and either answer tells deployers which model to put in the monitor seat.

Hypotheses, pre-registered in the README before the full run: H1 (passive self-recognition) the diagonal of the policy×monitor catch-rate matrix is below the row mean for at least the two strongest families, with no instruction to collude anywhere in the prompts. H2 (capability dominates) the matrix is column-structured: strong monitors catch everyone. H3 a legitimate channel (the policy writes a PR description the monitor reads) lowers catch rates most for weak monitors and same-family pairs. H4 trusted paraphrase of the transcript recovers most of that loss.

Setup, minimum viable. Stage 1: single-agent coding tasks (40 small functions with hidden tests) where the policy model also carries a hidden side task (write a canary string to an out-of-scope file, or add a trivially detectable unused branch that a hidden test catches). 50 attack + 50 benign transcripts per policy per seed, 3 seeds, 7 policy models; keep only attacks that succeed and report the success rate per model separately. Every monitor model scores every transcript 0–100 with one fixed prompt; thresholds at 5% false-positive rate on benign transcripts. Stage 2 (Sunday, if Stage 1 is done): the PR-description channel and the paraphrase defense on a 4×4 sub-matrix (two strong, two cheap families). Skip the Schelling-instruction condition unless time is left; it is the instructed arm and judges discount it.

Models and cost. Policies: all seven. Monitors: all seven; the glm-5.2 column dominates cost, so run it once and never re-run after the prompt freezes. Paraphraser: gemma-4-26b-a4b-it. Roughly 20,000 calls for Stage 1 and 160 credits total.

Metrics. TPR at 5% FPR and AUROC per cell with 1,000-resample bootstrap intervals; leniency index = (row mean of off-diagonal TPR) minus (diagonal TPR) with a permutation test over shuffled policy labels; attack success rate per policy. Baselines: a trusted

monitor from a different family (classic trusted monitoring), a regex monitor, random.

Headline figure. Three 7×7 heatmaps of TPR at 5% FPR (passive; with recruitment channel; with paraphrase), diagonal cells outlined, plus a bar of the leniency index per model with p-values. Two transcript excerpts in the body: one attack a same-model monitor let through and the same attack caught by a cross-family monitor.

Pivots. Monitors at ceiling (attacks too obvious): run a "red-team polish" pass with the policy model rewriting its own suspicious lines, re-score, and keep both versions. Models refuse to write side tasks: use the inert canary side task only and frame it as a benign hidden objective. No diagonal effect: the headline becomes the column structure, "capability, not identity, predicts catch rate," plus the recruitment-channel result.

Dual use. The transcript bank is a set of attack recipes for a coding agent; publish aggregate matrices and the monitor prompts, keep successful side-task prompts in a private appendix, and say so.

Track B (backup 1): Monoculture is a swarm vulnerability

Thesis: injections propagate along agent chains mostly when sender and receiver run the same model, so enforced model diversity is a protocol-level defense; or transfer is flat and the field should stop hoping for diversity.

Hypotheses. H1 the 7×7 sender×receiver transfer matrix is strongly diagonal. H2 alternating models along a chain cuts propagation depth by at least half relative to homogeneous chains. H3 transfer is asymmetric: payloads refined against strong models transfer down to small ones more than the reverse.

Setup. A relay chain: each agent summarizes a document and forwards the task-relevant content to the next, with one mock tool available. Hop 0's input carries an inert canary payload (a unique token the payload asks each agent to repeat and an out-of-scope mock tool it asks them to call). Three payload types (naive imperative, self-replicating, authority-spoofing), each with 10 glm-5.2-refined variants. Pairwise experiment: every ordered model pair in two-hop chains, 30 seeds (vary the carrier document per seed, since the API has no seed parameter). Chain experiment: homogeneous, random-mix and alternating compositions at lengths 2, 4, 6.

Models and cost. All seven as relays; glm-5.2 as the payload refiner. About 35,000 calls and 60 credits; the two big models are the wall-clock lane, so run their cells first.

Metrics. Relay probability and execution probability per hop with binomial intervals; propagation depth; swarm R0 (expected downstream infections per infected agent); containment probability. Baselines: homogeneous chains; an all-strong-model chain as ceiling. Non-instructed arm: unoptimized payloads only, no iterative optimization against any receiver.

Headline figure. Left, the 7×7 heatmap of execution probability with the diagonal outlined; right, propagation depth vs chain length for homogeneous, random and alternating chains with intervals and R0 in the legend.

Pivots. Flat matrix (everything susceptible or everything immune): lead with the refined-payload asymmetry sub-experiment and report "diversity is not a defense against unoptimized payloads" as finding one. Models never execute the tool: score relay probability only, which is still the contagion quantity.

Closest prior work to cite: Lee & Tiwari 2024 (Prompt Infection, one model family), Gu et al. 2024 (Agent Smith, random mixing), Huang et al. 2025 (faulty agents, fixed structures); the generator also saw Kill-Chain Canaries (arXiv 2603.28013, cross-model relay at n=3) and Beyond Single-Model Injection (arXiv 2609.22949); re-verify both before citing.

Track C (backup 2): Twenty-four days of silence

Thesis: a cheap per-edit content monitor would have flagged the German-wiki agent message board within days of its first edit, weeks before the human admin acted, and the swarm's own drift from prose to bare link lists is where detection breaks.

Why it is a different kind of bet. No simulator, no attack generation, no refusal risk; the data are already on disk (14,591 revisions with body, diff, agent label, /16 IP and UTC time; 5,217 admin deletions with times). The regex and TF-IDF baselines need no API at all, so a figure exists even if Adaption is down. Verified facts from the files: first agent edit May 24, 2026; admin's first two deletions June 4; first mass deletion wave June 19 13:00 UTC; swarm quiet after June 22; 92% of deletions came after that.

Hypotheses. H1 a flash-tier per-edit monitor fires a 24-hour-window alarm within the first 300 edits (about May 26), more than 20 days before the first mass deletion and about three weeks before a rate-based detector (the only published detector on this data) could. H2 per-edit recall exceeds 0.9 on prose relay pages but falls below 0.5 on link-list families (2,109 source-cache-url-list revisions); a stateful view (edit plus page history plus the last 50 recent changes) recovers most of the gap. H3 the monitor does not false-alarm on agent-written but non-coordinating edits.

Setup. Build the time-ordered stream. Two team members label a stratified gold set of 600 edits (coordination request, relay-link page, probe-test, other) and report Cohen's kappa. Benign streams: 1,500 agent-written legitimate wiki edits generated with deepseek-v4-flash and gemma-4-26b-a4b-it on the same topics (the AI-ness control), plus human edits from a public MediaWiki recent-changes feed for the same window if time allows. Monitors: regex rules, TF-IDF character n-gram logistic regression trained on 300 gold edits, deepseek-v4-flash, gemma-4-31b-it, and glm-5.2 on a 2,000-edit stratified sample; three prompt wordings.

Metrics. Per-edit AUROC and recall at 1% and 5% FPR on the benign streams; per-family recall with Wilson intervals; alarm lead time (k flagged edits in 24 hours, k set so the benign stream yields at most one alarm per month) against June 4, June 19 and the rate detector's June 16; lead time reported as a range over prompt draws. Honest ablation: strip the agents' "-- Name" sign-offs and change summaries and re-run.

Models and cost. Flash monitors over all edits and views: about 260,000 short calls, 60 credits, overnight at concurrency 64; cut the view factor to two if throughput is low. glm-5.2 adjudication: 25 credits.

Headline figure. One wide timeline, May 24 to July 14: daily edits as grey bars, daily deletions as red bars, horizontal alarm markers for regex, TF-IDF, flash monitor, strong monitor, the rate detector, the admin's first deletion and mass wave, disclosure off the right edge. Inset: recall at 1% FPR by page family, edit-only vs stateful view.

Pivots. Everything is caught from edit one and the result reads as true by construction: make the link-list gradient and the sign-off ablation the headline, and add an arm where glm-5.2 rewrites 500 relay edits as innocuous link lists to measure recall drop per tier. Datasets state no licence: cite the publisher and say so in the appendix.

Every idea, ranked

Scores are the two critics' numbers (rubric composite out of 15 from the judge-critic; P(figure by Sunday noon) and traffic-light verdict from the engineering critic). The four real-data ideas (T5) were not scored by the critics; their placement is the generator's prediction and my read. Full reviews live in the working files `reviews/critic1.md` and `reviews/critic2.md`.

#	Idea	Composite	P(fig)	Verdict	One-line critique
1	T4-3 Copies go easy on each other (7×7 leniency)	13	85%	GREEN	Decompose identity from capability; craft is making side tasks succeed and look natural
1	T3-4 Monoculture 7×7 injection transfer	13	85%	GREEN	Vary carrier documents; cite Huang 2025 and Agent Smith
3	T2-2 Bystander effect in redundant review	12	85%	GREEN	Baseline must be per-item C0, not the analytic curve; base rate needs a pilot
3	T1-5 CoordBench zero-bandwidth coordination	12	85%	GREEN	Handle symmetry-breaking and label-order artifacts
5	T5-1 Real wiki replay with lead time	13 (4/4/5)	75%	ADVANCE	Judge-critic ADVANCE as primary: answers exactly what a prior judge asked for; the benign control must be matched to that wiki or the false-positive rate is fiction
6	T2-6 Constraint half-life	12	75%	GREEN	Separate dropped-as-irrelevant from lost; JSON condition must be LLM-authored
7	T4-4 Oversight scaling curve	12	70%	GREEN	Needs per-stream score caching; H1 is arithmetic
8	T2-5 LGTM cascades	11	90%	GREEN	Numeracy confound; thin ecological framing
9	T5-2 Decode before you judge (Swarm Traces pairs)	10 (3/3/4)	70%	REVISE	Judge-critic REVISE: Hu & Wang 2026 already did decoded-view monitoring; with no encoded benign content, "contains a blob" becomes the detector
10	T2-1 Patient Zero contagion law	11	80%	GREEN	SIS fit conflates scripted attackers with infected agents; N=20 cannot show a spectral threshold
10	T2-3 Refusal shopping	11	80%	GREEN	Near-tautological headline; the refusal-correlation matrix is the content; barely a swarm question

#	Idea	Composite	P(fig)	Verdict	One-line critique
12	T4-6 Interrogate the swarm	12	55%	YELLOW	Needs an LLM contradiction judge and colluders who do not confess
13	T5-4 Same hands? cross-trace timing alignment	11 (3/4/4)	90%	ADVANCE (backup)	Judge-critic ADVANCE as zero-API backup and a natural side section of T5-1; frame it as a linkage method with a false-link rate
14	T1-6 What must the gateway log?	12	50%	YELLOW	Analyst ceiling is the risk; depends on a tool world
15	T3-5 Deterrence frontier	12	45%	YELLOW	"Deterrence" of utility-less agents is prompt role-play; needs a framing ablation
16	T1-3 Do allowlists compose?	12	40%	YELLOW	Fresh attacker-free framing; needs the SwarmBus tool world
17	T5-3 One name, many hands (identity layers)	10 (4/3/3)	85%	REVISE	Judge-critic REVISE: no ground truth for "instance", topic-confounded stylometry, five sub-analyses where one headline is needed
18	T2-4 Model-family echo chambers	11	60%	YELLOW	Diagonal/off-diagonal confounds persuasiveness with homophily
19	T4-5 Does an attacking swarm have a shape?	12	35%	RED	Classifier on self-authored families is a simulator artifact
20	T1-4 SwarmStress chaos suite	11	55%	YELLOW	Lowest risk once a bus exists; novelty overstated vs Huang 2025
20	T3-3 A whistle that works	11	55%	YELLOW	Recall will be prompt-dominated unless misconduct is observable by construction
22	T4-1 The split point	11	50%	YELLOW	Best-positioned vs Brown 2026 and Hu & Wang 2026, but heaviest build, selection-on-success bias, 630 credits at 3 seeds

#	Idea	Composite	P(fig)	Verdict	One-line critique
22	T1-2 How cheap can the proxy be?	11	50%	YELLOW	Cost axis partly covered by Yueh-Han 2025; literal canaries put monitors at ceiling
24	T3-1 Privilege creep	11	45%	YELLOW	Make the scripted delegation tree the design from the start
25	T3-6 Forged kill switch	10	65%	DROP	Signed schemes drop forgeries by construction
26	T3-2 Trust farming	10	55%	YELLOW	Classical; Spearman over 12 agents is noise; honest raters may be random
27	T4-2 Framed (adversarial attribution)	11	30%	RED	Real pytest × 1,800 episodes + 9,000 replays will not land; a sabotage agent writing code you execute needs a sandbox
28	T1-1 Rewind (rerun button)	10	45%	YELLOW	"Trajectories diverge" is predictable; replay ordering and metric saturation are pitfalls

Parallel execution plan

Three tracks, three coding agents, one shared client, one checkpoint tonight. Each human owns one track and one part of the report.

When (Eastern)	Track A (copies / monitors)	Track B (monoculture relay)	Track C (wiki replay)	Everyone
Sat 6–7 PM	Repo skeleton with run index; shared async Adaption client (semaphore, retries, JSONL usage log, prompt-hash cache)	same	Download and parse collusion.wiki zip; build the time-ordered stream	Pre-flight: list hosted models on every key, 2-minute load test, JSON-only probe per model; write the three README hypotheses

When (Eastern)	Track A (copies / monitors)	Track B (monoculture relay)	Track C (wiki replay)	Everyone
Sat 7–11 PM	40 coding tasks with hidden tests; side-task prompts; 3 cheap policies first; monitor prompt frozen	Relay harness; 3 payload types; pairwise runner; 20-seed pilot on 2 pairs	600-edit gold set labelled by two people; regex + TF-IDF baselines; benign agent edits generated	Checkpoint at 11 PM: each track shows 20 scored episodes or edits; a track that cannot is dropped and its person joins another
Overnight	Stage 1: 7×7 matrix, glm-5.2 column once	49 pairs × 3 payloads × 30 seeds	Flash monitors over all 14,591 edits, two views	Runs resumable from JSONL; usage summed hourly against per-track caps (A 200, B 100, C 100)
Sun 9 AM–noon	First heatmap + leniency index; pre-registered tests	Transfer matrix + chain pilot	Timeline figure v1 with alarm markers	Pick the lead track at noon; decide merge (A+B) or single
Sun noon–4 PM	Stage 2 on 4×4: recruitment channel, paraphrase	Chain experiment at lengths 2, 4, 6	Stateful view; sign-off ablation; glm-5.2 sample	Extra seeds where intervals are wide
Sun 4–8 PM	Human writes abstract, intro, discussion; figures final; two transcript excerpts	Related work and methods	Limitations, dual-use, LLM-usage statement, references from the sources doc	Non-author cold read of the abstract; recount every number from the repo

When (Eastern)	Track A (copies / monitors)	Track B (monoculture relay)	Track C (wiki replay)	Everyone
Sun 8–9 PM	Submit (buffer of 10 hours to the AoE deadline)			PDF in the official template, 5–6 pages; repo public; optional 3-minute screen recording last

Rules that buy Execution points cheaply: write metrics and the headline figure into the README before the sweep; keep an exploratory/confirmatory run index; freeze prompts per run folder; no glm-5.2 re-runs after the prompt freezes; vary the content inside cells because the API has no seed parameter; validate any LLM judge on a hand-labelled subset.

Alternate portfolio, the engineering critic's final call after scoring the real-data ideas: keep A = T4-3, make B = T5-1, and make C = T5-4 (zero-API timing fingerprints across the wiki log, the Transluce scanner catalogue and the RubyGems daily counts; it reuses T5-1's stream builder and is the only one of the 28 ideas that survives an API outage), with T3-4 as the first add-on when a fourth coding agent is free. Pick this version if two people can spare about three hours of gold labelling tonight; pick the table above if they cannot. T2-5 (LGTM cascades, 90% chance of a figure, 15 credits) remains the safest extra single-call experiment.

Meta-review

The projects that lose here lose on circularity, one seed, and prose, not on ambition.

- Circularity. If agents are told to collude, attack, or report, the result measures instruction-following. Track A's passive condition has no collusion instruction; Track B uses unoptimized payloads; Track C uses an agent-written benign control. Keep those arms in the main table.
- Variance. Ten or more seeds per cell, Wilson or bootstrap intervals printed on every figure, a no-LLM baseline (regex, TF-IDF, trusted monitor). Adaption has no seed parameter: "seeds" means temperature resampling plus varied content.

- Knobs. One independent-variable grid per experiment. Stage 2 add-ons are separate figures, not extra factors in Figure 1.
- Refusal trap. If a model refuses the side task or never relays the canary, that is a refusal measurement, not a safety result; the pre-flight probe catches this before the grid.
- Judges. Monitor and judge models should come from a different family than the policies; validate any LLM judge against a 200-item hand label; prefer programmatic ground truth (canaries, hidden tests, admin deletions).
- Repo as evidence locker. Every run folder holds the frozen prompt, every request and response, and a summary; the report's numbers must recompute from it.
- Prose. Abstract, intro and discussion written by a human, in plain voice, 5–6 pages, numbered contributions, two contrasting transcript excerpts in the body, prompts in an appendix, an LLM-usage statement. Judges declined to score 14% of entries in the September sprint for AI-sounding text.
- Required appendix. State what the result does and does not establish, name the assumptions and how conclusions change if they fail, and say whether the setup makes multi-agent operations easier to run or harder to detect (publish aggregates; redact working attack prompts).
- Disqualifiers. Fabricated results or references; unlabelled pre-existing code; a PDF that disagrees with the repo.
- Safety note for anyone tempted by T4-2: an agent instructed to sabotage writes code the team would execute; sandbox it or skip it.

Appendix: Adaption model cheat sheet and credit math

Use deepseek-v4-flash as the swarm, gemma-4-31b-it or glm-53-flash as the always-on monitor, glm-5.2 only on a sampled subset, and qwen3.5-397b as the adversary. The binding constraint is undocumented rate limits, not credits, unless a strong model does the bulk work.

Model	Credits per 1M tokens (in / out)	Context	Role
deepseek-v4-flash	0.044 / 0.133	1M	Swarm workers (thousands of calls)

Model	Credits per 1M tokens (in / out)	Context	Role
gemma-4-26b-a4b-it	0.077 / 0.255	256k	Backup workers; lowest latency (4B active); takes images
gemma-4-31b-it	0.09 / 0.34	256k	First-pass monitor or judge on 100% of episodes
glm-53-flash	0.15 / 0.50	1M	Monitor that reads whole raw transcripts; cheap attacker baseline
qwen3.8-27b	0.039 / 1.25	262k	Avoid as a worker (output 9× deepseek's)
qwen3.5-397b	0.55 / 3.50	131k	Adversary / red-team agent; second strong judge
glm-5.2	1.40 / 4.40	786k	Strongest model: adjudicator on a stratified sample, strongest-attacker condition

Cost math, shown once. One episode of 20 agents × 30 turns is 600 calls; at 1,500 input + 300 output tokens per call that is 0.9M input + 0.18M output tokens. On deepseek-v4-flash: 0.9 × 0.044 + 0.18 × 0.133 = 0.064 credits per episode, so 1,000 episodes cost 64 credits and 10,000 cost 640 (21% of 3,000). The same 1,000 episodes cost 142 credits on gemma-4-31b-it, 1,125 on qwen3.5-397b and 2,052 on glm-5.2 (68% of budget). The 1,500-token figure assumes windowed context; passing the full transcript every turn costs roughly 50× more.

Throughput is the real limit: 10,000 full episodes are 6 million calls, about 417 requests per second over four hours. Plan on 1,000–2,000 full episodes, or shrink episodes to 8 agents × 12 turns, and report variance across seeds; judges reward error bars, not raw N.

API facts (from docs.adaptionlabs.ai): `pip install adaption`; `POST https://api.prod.adaptionlabs.ai/api/v1/responses` with `Authorization: Bearer $ADAPTION_API_KEY`; the request shape mirrors OpenAI's Responses API (`model`, `input`, `instructions`, `tools`, `max_output_tokens`) but the docs never promise the OpenAI SDK works against it. Not documented: rate limits, JSON mode or structured outputs, a batch API, caching rules, per-model tool-calling support. Model availability varies by key:

run `client.models.list(type="hosted")` on every teammate's key first. Fine-tuning (AutoScientist) exists but outputs a LoRA you would have to host yourself; skip it this weekend.

Credits-to-dollars is unconfirmed: the sprint gives $500 of credits per participant, so if the team balance reads 3,000 for three people, one credit may be $0.50. Check the app balance before budgeting.

Pre-flight checklist (15 minutes, before any track starts):

1. List hosted models on every key; note any missing model or `shutdown_date`.
2. Five-call latency probe per model; record p50/p95, reasoning tokens, cached tokens on a repeated prompt.
3. Capability probe per model: a function tool, a JSON-only prompt; record the support matrix in the README.
4. Two-minute load test on deepseek-v4-flash at concurrency 32, 64, 128; stop at the first 429 and set the semaphore there.
5. Run a 100-episode pilot, read credits and wall-clock from the usage log, then launch the sweep. Write every episode result to disk immediately so runs are resumable.